With the development server running, you can see the results of your hard work by visiting: http://localhost:8000/credits/. If you've wired everything together correctly, it should look like figure 2.5. When you're done admiring your accomplishment, press CTRL-C to exit the development server.

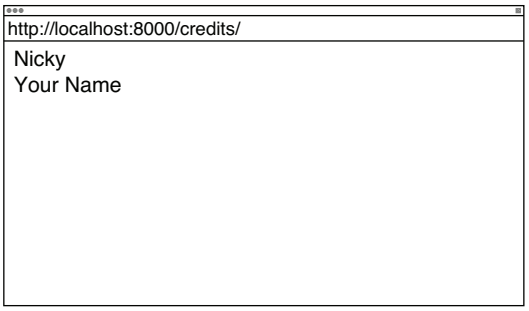


Figure 2.5 Your first Django view

You've got your first project built and your first view written, and you have enough information to build an entire website. Everything else is about how to make fancier and fancier views, but the cornerstone has been laid. Each page you add to your site will be another view. Instead of your view returning plain text, you can return HTML. HTML is verbose. Because of this, Django includes tools to manage it more like code, through the use of templates. You can write reusable parts and compose them together. That is the next step.

2.8 Exercises

For a bit of practice, try to adapt your code to do the following:

1. Add an About page to the site, using the same techniques as you did for the Credits page. Instead of using plain text, have the content block contain valid HTML content.
2. Add a Version Info page that contains the version number of your site. Instead of using plain text, return valid JSON. You can do this by adapting the MIME type or using a `django.http.JsonResponse` object instead. Details on the `JsonResponse` object can be found in the documentation: http://mng.bz/qOox.

Summary

- Django is a framework, rather than a library, meaning your code gets called by Django, not the other way around.
- Django calls a website a *project*.
- You create a Django project using the `django-admin startproject` command. This creates skeleton files for your website.
- Django projects contain a configuration directory that has the same name as the project directory. This directory includes the URL mapping file (urls.py) and a script that specifies configuration settings (settings.py).
- The code for your website goes in modules that Django calls *apps*.
- You create a new app using the `python manage.py startapp` command. This creates skeleton files for your app.